

TALAL AL ZAYED

POLICY · TECHNOLOGY · BUILDER

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10+

YEARS IN POLICY

\$200M+

REVENUE PROTECTED

3

MARKETS COVERED

G20

POLICY AUTHOR

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Public policy executive operating at the intersection of MENA government affairs, technology regulation, and Vision 2030 implementation. Over a decade unlocking commercial outcomes for global technology leaders and sovereign institutions through regulatory advocacy, institutional design, and multilateral diplomacy. Track record spans reversing a \$200M+ import restriction for HP, founding the Public Policy Department at the Royal Commission for AIUla, and authoring the G20 Finance Track's flagship document under Saudi Arabia's Presidency. Trusted advisor to ministerial counterparts across KSA, UAE, and Egypt on AI governance, foreign direct investment, local content, and digital transformation.

CORE COMPETENCIES

G20 & Multilateral Diplomacy · AI Governance & Digital Transformation · Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) · Local Content & Government Procurement · Cloud & Data Sovereignty Policy · Vision 2030 Alignment · Public Policy Lifecycle · C-Suite & Ministerial Advisory · Anti-Counterfeit & IP Protection · Regulatory Strategy & Advocacy · Public-Private Partnerships · Commercial Diplomacy

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Public Policy and Government Affairs

HP Inc. — Saudi Arabia, UAE & Egypt

May 2024 — Present

- Reversed a restrictive SASO import standard threatening **\$200M+ in annual revenue** by orchestrating a multi-stakeholder advocacy campaign with the Ministry of Commerce, SASO, and industry coalitions—safeguarding HP's full product portfolio and uninterrupted market access across KSA.
- Leading HP's enterprise-wide strategy to secure enlistment on Saudi Arabia's **mandatory government procurement list** under the Local Content & Government Procurement Authority (LCGPA), positioning HP for preferential access to multi-billion riyal public-sector tenders and embedding the company in Vision 2030's localization framework.
- Spearheading high-level negotiations with Saudi government counterparts on a strategic **incentives package** supporting HP's expanded Kingdom investment footprint, advancing localization commitments and unlocking long-term commercial advantage.
- Negotiated government partnerships supporting HP's investment roadmap, directly contributing to the establishment of **Saudi Arabia's first AI Center of Excellence at KFUPM**.
- Launched HP's national digital equity initiative with relative entities, providing **700,000+ Saudi students** access to advanced technology courses.
- Built and directed a regulatory intelligence function monitoring **20+ new regulations per quarter** across three markets—enabling HP to pre-position on 3 major compliance shifts ahead of competitors.
- Led cross-functional anti-counterfeit strategy integrating government enforcement, channel partnerships, and market intelligence—**reducing illicit HP products by 35%**.
- Deployed an AI-powered MENA policy intelligence system tracking **40+ government sources**, cutting manual monitoring time by **70%** and surfacing regulatory risks in near real-time. Principal HP interlocutor across 3 markets, engaging ministerial counterparts at MoC, SASO, MoE, MOIAT, and TDRA.

Public Policy Advisor — Founding Department Head

Royal Commission for AlUla (RCU)

Jun 2021 — Apr 2024

- Founded and led the Public Policy Department from the ground up for a **\$15B+ sovereign mega-program**, building a **5-member team**, managing a **SAR 15M departmental budget**, and establishing charter, governance frameworks, and stakeholder protocols.
- Engineered a regulatory governance framework that **accelerated the policy-making lifecycle by 50%**, reducing bottlenecks and enhancing investor confidence across the destination.
- Authored AlUla's first **agricultural productivity policy**, converting unproductive land into a working agricultural supply base feeding hospitality and F&B operators across the destination—catalyzing local economic activity and advancing food security objectives.
- Drafted Saudi Arabia's proposed **Art Law**—the first dedicated legal framework of its kind in the Kingdom—creating the regulatory infrastructure for AlUla to host international art auctions and positioning Saudi Arabia as a regional cultural and art-market hub.
- Led regulatory mapping for newly transferred entities, resolving **90+ critical policy gaps** to streamline the investment environment.
- Advised senior RCU leadership on land use, environmental, and heritage policy, shaping regulatory positions adopted at the ministerial level.

G20 Economic Policy Advisor

Saudi Arabian Monetary Authority (SAMA) — G20 Finance Track

Feb 2019 — Jun 2021

- Authored "*Menu of Policy Options: Access to Opportunities for All*"—the **G20 Finance Track's flagship document** under Saudi Arabia's historic G20 Presidency, formally adopted across member nations and shaping the global agenda on inclusive growth.
- Directed multilateral advocacy and consensus-building across **20 member nations and 12 international organizations** on inclusive growth and digital financial inclusion.
- Conceived and orchestrated the inaugural **G20 Deputy Ministers' Symposium**, establishing the template adopted for subsequent senior-level G20 side events.

Economic Specialist

Monshaat — Small & Medium Enterprises General Authority

Feb 2017 — Feb 2019

- Authored the foundational policy proposal that established the case for **Saudi Arabia's first dedicated SME Bank**, conducting access-to-finance gap analysis that quantified the structural funding shortfall and recommended a sovereign-backed lending vehicle to close it.
- Led a cross-agency team in developing a national policy framework to **reduce government-imposed costs on SMEs**, streamlining compliance burdens and improving operating economics for the sector.
- Established **Saudi Arabia's first national SME Data Center** in partnership with the Ministry of Commerce, creating the foundational dataset for evidence-based SME policy.
- Led development of the **National SME Strategy**, securing ministerial endorsement of core growth initiatives under Vision 2030.

Economic Analyst

The Royal Court — Vision 2030 Foundation Team

Sep 2015 — Feb 2017

- Drove cross-functional policy interventions on Energy Price Reforms and National Support Programs, coordinating delivery across **6 government agencies**.
- Co-authored "*Diversifying the Income of Saudi Arabia*"—foundational research that informed core economic diversification components of **Vision 2030**.

EDUCATION

Master of Public Policy (Expected 2027) — KAPSARC School of Public Policy

MBA, Entrepreneurship (2019) — Mohammed Bin Salman College

Bachelor of Economics (2014) — Trent University, Canada

AFFILIATIONS, CERTIFICATIONS & LANGUAGES

Affiliations: Tech Committee Member, American Chamber of Commerce in Saudi Arabia (AmCham KSA) · Author, G20 Finance Track Flagship Document (2020) · Policy commentary at talalalzayed.com

Certifications: Implementing Public Policy — Harvard Kennedy School · Public Policy Analysis — London School of Economics · Regulation — London School of Economics · Change Management — PROSCI Certified · Project Management Professional (PMP) — PMI · Programming for Data Science with Python — Udacity

Languages: Arabic (Native) · English (Fluent)